

Document Module Requirements

1. Create a New Document

When a user creates a document, they will have two options:

A. Normal Document

A normal document will go through the standard review and approval process.

The user will provide:

- Document name
- Document type
- Effective date (auto generated after approval based on configuration)
- Related review documents
- Reference documents
- One or more reviewers
- One QA approver
- Document file

B. Pre-Approved / External Document

A pre-approved/external document is a document that has already been approved externally and is being stored in the system as a document repository.

The user will provide:

- Document name
- Document type
- Related review documents
- Reference documents
- Document file

An effective date is **not required** for a pre-approved/external document.

A pre-approved/external document will not have the option to select reviewers or a QA approver. The user will sign the document when submitting it. This is simply an acknowledgement that the user understands they are uploading the document; it does not initiate a review or approval process.

For these documents:

- No custom header, footer, or metadata pages will be added.
- A download stamp will still be added when the user downloads the file.

File Upload and Conversion

When a user uploads a supported file that can be converted to PDF, such as Word (DOC/DOCX), Excel spreadsheets, or PowerPoint presentations:

- Before submission, the user will see the document rendered in its original file format.
- Once submitted, the file will be uploaded and converted to PDF.
- Once it is approved, the system will add the custom header and footer, along with the first- and last-page metadata.
- The PDF download stamp will only be added when the user downloads the document.
- The user will also be able to download the original file they uploaded.

If audio, video, or other file types are supported in the future, the option to add a stamp when the user downloads the file may not be available.

Draft and Submission

Once the document is created, the user can either:

- Save it as **Draft**, or
- Submit it for review.

For a normal document, once submitted, the status changes to **In Review**.

Only when the document is **In Review** can reviewers add their review.

For a pre-approved/external document, submission completes the upload and acknowledgement process without requiring review or approval.

Review

A normal document can have one or more reviewers and one QA approver.

If there are multiple reviewers, **all reviewers must approve the document before it is sent to QA for approval**.

Each reviewer can:

- Approve the document, or
- Add a comment if changes are required.

If a reviewer adds a comment, the document is rejected and moved back to **Draft**, allowing the author to update the document and re-upload it.

Once all reviewers have approved the document, it moves to the QA approval stage.

The QA approver can:

- Approve the document, or
- Add a comment if changes are required.

If QA adds a comment, the document is rejected and moved back to **Draft**, allowing the author to update the document and re-upload it.

Once QA approves the document, the final status becomes **Approved**.

Effective Date

For now, the effective date for a normal document will be set to **two weeks after approval**.

This will apply across all applicable document types for the MVP.

The effective-date rule will later be made **configurable per document type**.

QA will also have the option to **override the effective date as part of the review process**.

An effective date is not required for pre-approved/external documents.

Original File Access During Review

Reviewers and QA approvers will have the option to download the original uploaded file.

They will still be able to view the converted PDF in the browser, but if PDF conversion affects the formatting or makes the document difficult to review, they can download the original file for reference.

They will not be able to upload or replace the file. They can only download it for review and must add their comments in the system and reject the document if changes are required.

Pre-Approved Attachments

Each document can have pre-approved attachments.

For now, the limit will be **five attachments per document**.

These attachments:

- Will be accessible to users.
- Will not be updated as part of the document workflow.
- Will not be reviewed or approved as part of the document review and approval process.

2. Create a New Version of an Approved Document

Once a document is **Approved**, the user will have options to:

- Download the PDF
- Print the document
- Create a new version
- Download the original uploaded file

When creating a new version:

- The user can update the document fields.
- The original document ID cannot be changed.
- The version number will automatically increment.
- The user can download the original file, make changes to it, and upload it as the new version.
- The new version will then go through the same review and approval workflow as the original document.
- The same document conversion, review, approval, effective-date, and download-stamping rules will apply to the new version.

Once the new version is approved, the previous version will be marked as **Superseded**.

3. Mark a Document as Obsolete

A document can be marked as **Obsolete** when it is no longer required or in use.

This applies to:

- Draft documents
- Documents in review
- Approved documents
- Pre-approved/external documents

Draft Document

The original author can mark a document that is in **Draft** as **Obsolete**.

The author will need to provide a comment when marking it as Obsolete.

Document in Review

If a document is currently in review and the author wants to stop the process:

1. The reviewer or QA approver must reject the document.
2. The document moves back to **Draft**.
3. The original author can then mark the document as **Obsolete**.
4. The author must provide a comment.
5. The document is marked as **Obsolete**.

Approved Document

An approved document can be marked as **Obsolete** when it is no longer required or in use.

The author will need to provide a comment.

Pre-Approved / External Document

A pre-approved/external document can also be marked as **Obsolete** when it is no longer required or in use.

The author will need to provide a comment.

Obsolete Documents

Obsolete documents will remain **searchable** in the system.

A status filter can be added later if required to make it easier for users to filter Obsolete documents.

Document Lifecycle Summary

Normal Document:

Draft → In Review → Reviewer Approval(s) → QA Approval → Approved

If changes are required:

In Review → Rejected → Draft → Update / Re-upload → In Review

After approval:

Approved → New Version → In Review → QA Approval → Approved

When a new version is approved:

Previous Version → Superseded

At any appropriate point, a document can be:

→ **Obsolete**

Pre-Approved / External Document:

Draft → Submitted / Signed → Approved

There is no reviewer or QA approval process for pre-approved/external documents. The submission signature is simply an acknowledgement by the user that they are uploading the document for use in the system.